

Glimpses of India + The Trees

Class 10 CBSE • First Flight • Chapter 5 (All Three Parts) + Corresponding Poem

Detailed Exam-Oriented Solutions

Prose: A Baker from Goa • Coorg • Tea from Assam | Poem: The Trees

Complete textbook questions/activities, character & place sketches, vocabulary, important lines, extracts, very-short/short/long answers, value-based questions, additional questions, CBSE competency questions and MCQs.

1. Chapter Information

Title	Glimpses of India
Part I	A Baker from Goa — Lucio Rodrigues
Part II	Coorg — Lokesh Abrol
Part III	Tea from Assam — Arup Kumar Datta
Genre	Descriptive prose / travel and cultural writing
Poem	The Trees — Adrienne Rich
Focus	Regional culture, traditions, landscapes, food, occupations and tea cultivation in India

2. Character / Place Sketches

A Baker from Goa — The Baker

The Goan baker represents an old Portuguese-influenced tradition. Bakers were an essential part of village life, and bread was associated with daily meals as well as special occasions. The baker's traditional dress, bamboo staff, rhythmic call and early-morning visits show the continuity of the profession.

A Baker from Goa — The Narrator

The narrator remembers the baker with affection and nostalgia. His memories show how deeply the baker and his bread were connected with childhood, family life and Goan cultural heritage.

Coorg — The People

The Kodavus are described as brave, independent and hospitable people. The chapter links them with a strong martial tradition and notes their distinctive culture, food and lifestyle.

Coorg — The Landscape

Coorg is portrayed as a beautiful hill region of evergreen forests, coffee plantations, spices, wildlife and streams. Its pleasant climate and natural scenery make it an attractive tourist destination.

Tea from Assam — Pranjol and Rajvir

Pranjol is from Assam and is familiar with tea plantations because his father manages one. Rajvir is curious and enthusiastic about tea. Their conversation introduces the reader to tea legends, history and cultivation.

Tea from Assam — Pranjol's Father

His work as a tea-garden manager connects the boys' journey with the world of tea cultivation and the economic importance of Assam's plantations.

3. Important Words & Meanings

plump	fat or pleasantly rounded
pader	traditional village baker in Goa
convent	a religious community or institution
nostalgia	a sentimental longing for the past
loaves	large quantities/shapes of baked bread
furnace	a very hot enclosed place used for heating or baking
hunks	large rough pieces
peculiar	strange or unusual
familiar	well known from experience
rejoice	feel or show great joy
martial	related to war or soldiers
valour	great courage in danger
hospitality	friendly and generous treatment of guests
reverie	a pleasant state of dreamy thought
boulder	a large rounded rock
canopies	coverings formed by branches/leaves
exotic	unusual and attractive because it comes from a distant place
slopes	sides of hills or mountains
legends	traditional stories or beliefs
plantation	large area where crops are cultivated commercially
sprouting	beginning to grow
pruned	cut back branches to control plant growth
lush	growing thickly and healthily

4. Important Quotations / Lines

"Our elders are often heard reminiscing nostalgically about those good old Portuguese days and their famous loaves of bread."

Significance: The line shows the lasting Portuguese influence on Goan food and memories.

"The baker's furnace was essential in the old days."

Significance: Bread-making had become an established and important part of Goan life.

"Coorg, or Kodagu, the smallest district of Karnataka, is home to evergreen rainforests, spices and coffee plantations."

Significance: Coorg is presented as a region where natural beauty, agriculture and distinctive culture exist together.

“The air was filled with the sour, sweet smell of tea.”

Significance: The sensory description creates a vivid picture of the tea plantation and Rajvir’s excitement.

“Tea came to Europe only in the sixteenth century and was drunk more for medicinal purposes than as a beverage.”

Significance: The statement introduces the historical background of tea.

“The trees inside are moving out into the forest.”

Significance: The trees are personified as living beings seeking freedom and their natural space.

5. Complete NCERT Textbook Solutions — Prose

Part I — A Baker from Goa: Read and Find Out

Q. What are the elders in Goa nostalgic about?

Answer: They are nostalgic about the Portuguese days and the traditional Goan bread that was an important part of everyday life and celebrations.

Q. Is bread-making still popular in Goa? How do you know?

Answer: Yes. The chapter shows that the traditional baking profession and furnaces continued, and bread remained important for daily life and social and religious occasions.

Q. What is the baker called?

Answer: The baker is traditionally called a ‘pader’ in Goa.

Q. When would the baker come everyday? Why did the children run to meet him?

Answer: The baker came early in the morning. The children eagerly waited for him because they loved the bread-bangles and other bread products he brought.

Part I — A Baker from Goa: Think About It

Q. Why was the baker’s profession profitable?

Answer: Bread was consumed regularly and was also essential for festivals and ceremonies, so bakers had steady demand for their products.

Q. Why did the children not care about brushing their teeth before meeting the baker?

Answer: They were excited about the fresh bread and bread-bangles and were more interested in getting the treats than in their morning routine.

Q. Describe the traditional Goan baker’s importance to society.

Answer: The baker was a familiar community figure. His daily visits and bread were connected with childhood, family life, festivals and celebrations, so his profession reflected an important part of Goan heritage.

Part II — Coorg: Read and Find Out

Q. Where is Coorg?

Answer: Coorg, also called Kodagu, is the smallest district of Karnataka and lies midway between Mysore and the coastal town of Mangalore.

Q. What is the story about the Kodavu people’s descent?

Answer: One theory suggests that the Kodavus may be of Greek or Arabic origin. The text presents this as a possible explanation based on customs and traditions.

Q. What are some of the things you know about the people of Coorg?

Answer: They are known for bravery, hospitality and a strong martial tradition. Many Kodavus serve in the armed forces, and they have distinctive customs.

Q. What is the best season to visit Coorg?

Answer: The chapter recommends the period from September to March as a pleasant time to visit.

Q. What is Coorg famous for?

Answer: Coorg is famous for coffee plantations, evergreen forests, spices, wildlife, scenic beauty and adventure activities.

Q. What is a traditional belief about the river Kaveri?

Answer: The river Kaveri is associated with a sacred spring at Talacauvery, which is traditionally regarded as its source.

Part II — Coorg: Think About It

Q. Why is Coorg called a piece of heaven?

Answer: Its evergreen forests, coffee plantations, spices, hills, streams, wildlife and pleasant climate create an exceptionally beautiful natural environment.

Q. What activities can tourists enjoy in Coorg?

Answer: Visitors can enjoy trekking, river rafting, canoeing, mountain climbing, fishing and exploring wildlife and coffee plantations.

Q. What does the description of the Kodavus suggest about their culture?

Answer: It suggests a culture that values courage, hospitality, independence and martial traditions.

Part III — Tea from Assam: Read and Find Out

Q. What are the legends about the discovery of tea?

Answer: One Indian legend says tea plants grew where a Buddhist ascetic's eyelids fell after he cut them off to prevent sleep. A Chinese legend says tea leaves fell into boiling water and produced a pleasant flavour.

Q. Where was tea first drunk?

Answer: Tea is traditionally associated with China as one of its earliest known places of use.

Q. Why was tea introduced to Britain?

Answer: Tea became popular in Britain as its use and trade expanded, and British interest later contributed to large-scale tea cultivation in India.

Q. What is the name of the tea plantation visited by Rajvir and Pranjol?

Answer: They visit Pranjol's father's tea plantation in Assam.

Q. What did Rajvir see on his journey through Assam?

Answer: He saw vast stretches of tea bushes, tea-pluckers and the characteristic landscape of the tea-growing region.

Part III — Tea from Assam: Think About It

Q. What was Rajvir's reaction to the tea plantations?

Answer: Rajvir was fascinated and excited because he had read about tea and its history and now saw the plantations in reality.

Q. Why did Pranjol not share Rajvir's excitement to the same extent?

Answer: Pranjol had grown up in Assam and was accustomed to tea gardens, so what seemed extraordinary to Rajvir was familiar to him.

Q. What does the chapter tell us about the importance of tea in India?

Answer: It presents tea as an important agricultural product and a major part of everyday consumption and commercial life.

Part I-III: Integrated Questions

Q. How do the three parts together create a picture of India?

Answer: They present different regions through food, people, landscape, occupations, history and culture. Goa shows Portuguese influence and baking traditions; Coorg presents natural beauty and a distinctive culture; Assam presents tea plantations and agricultural life.

Q. What common feature connects all three parts?

Answer: All three use a particular region, occupation or natural feature to reveal the cultural and geographical diversity of India.

THE POEM — THE TREES

Poet: Adrienne Rich

6. Poem Information

Title	The Trees
Poet	Adrienne Rich
Genre	Modern free-verse poem
Key Ideas	Freedom, confinement, nature, movement and return to the natural world
Central Image	Trees moving from a house towards the forest

7. Important Words & Meanings — The Trees

confined — kept within limits; restricted

veranda — a covered platform or passage outside a house

twigs — small thin branches

long-cramped — kept compressed or restricted for a long time

exertion — physical effort

crown — top part of a tree formed by branches and leaves

shuffling — moving with short dragging steps

lichen — a plant-like growth found on rocks and trees

hollows — empty spaces or cavities

whispering — speaking very softly

moonlight — light reflected from the moon

8. Poem — Section-wise Explanation

Trees confined inside the house

The poet imagines trees that have been kept inside a house for a long time. They are described as if they are living beings trying to escape confinement. The house contrasts with the forest, their natural home.

Roots and branches struggle outward

The roots work to free themselves from the veranda floor. Branches move and leaves press towards the glass. The trees' movement suggests a powerful desire for freedom.

The forest waits

The forest is presented as the trees' natural home. It appears empty because the trees that belong there are inside the house. Their return restores the natural order.

The night movement

At night the trees move outward. The moonlight and quiet setting create a mysterious atmosphere and emphasise the movement from confinement to open space.

The ending

The glass breaks and the trees move into the forest. The ending emphasises liberation and the return of nature to its rightful environment.

9. Important Quotations / Lines — The Trees

“The trees inside are moving out into the forest.”

Significance: The trees are personified as beings escaping confinement and returning to their natural habitat.

“The roots work to disengage themselves from the cracks in the veranda floor.”

Significance: The roots are given human-like effort and determination, showing the struggle for freedom.

“The glass is breaking.”

Significance: The breaking glass symbolises the destruction of the artificial barrier between the trees and the outside world.

“The moon is broken like a mirror.”

Significance: This striking image creates a visual impression of branches crossing the reflected moonlight.

“The night is fresh.”

Significance: The final atmosphere suggests renewal after the trees regain freedom.

10. Complete NCERT Textbook Solutions — The Trees

Q. What is the central contrast in the poem?

Answer: The central contrast is between the confined trees inside the house and their natural freedom in the forest.

Q. Why are the trees described as moving?

Answer: The trees are personified. Their movement symbolises nature’s urge for freedom and its return to its natural environment.

Q. What do the roots do?

Answer: The roots are imagined as working themselves free from the cracks in the veranda floor.

Q. Why are the leaves described as moving toward the glass?

Answer: The leaves are personified as trying to reach the outside world. Their movement suggests a desire to escape the confined space.

Q. What does the forest symbolise?

Answer: The forest symbolises natural freedom, belonging and the original environment of the trees.

Q. What does the breaking glass suggest?

Answer: It suggests that the barrier between the confined trees and the outside world is being destroyed. Symbolically, it represents liberation.

Q. Why is the moon imagery effective?

Answer: The moon imagery creates a vivid visual picture and emphasises the quiet, mysterious movement of the trees at night.

Q. What does the poem suggest about freedom?

Answer: It suggests that freedom is a powerful natural need and that living beings resist prolonged confinement.

11. Poetic Devices — The Trees

Personification — Trees, roots, branches and leaves are given human qualities such as moving, struggling and working.

Imagery — The poem creates visual images of roots, leaves, glass, forest, moonlight and night.

Symbolism — Trees symbolise living beings seeking freedom; the house suggests confinement; the forest suggests natural freedom.

Alliteration — Repetition of initial consonant sounds in nearby words creates musical effect in several phrases.

Enjambment — Thoughts continue from one line to the next, reflecting the continuous movement of the trees.

Simile — The moon is compared to a broken mirror, producing a striking visual image.

Contrast — Indoor confinement is contrasted with outdoor freedom and the forest.

12. Extract-Based Questions — Prose

“Our elders are often heard reminiscing nostalgically about those good old Portuguese days...”

1. What are the elders remembering?

Answer: The Portuguese period and its traditions.

2. What cultural item is associated with those days?

Answer: Traditional Goan bread and baking.

3. What does ‘nostalgically’ indicate?

Answer: They remember the past with affection and longing.

4. What does this reveal about Goan culture?

Answer: Portuguese influence remains part of Goan cultural memory.

“Coorg, or Kodagu, the smallest district of Karnataka, is home to evergreen rainforests...”

1. Where is Coorg?

Answer: In Karnataka, between Mysore and Mangalore.

2. Name two natural features.

Answer: Rainforests and coffee plantations.

3. Why is Coorg attractive to tourists?

Answer: Its scenery, climate, wildlife and adventure activities.

4. What does ‘evergreen’ suggest?

Answer: The forests remain green for much of the year.

“The air was filled with the sour, sweet smell of tea.”

1. Who experiences this?

Answer: Rajvir and Pranjol.

2. Where are the characters travelling?

Answer: Through Assam’s tea-growing region.

3. Which sense is appealed to?

Answer: The sense of smell.

4. What does the description achieve?

Answer: It makes the tea plantation vivid and sensory.

13. Extract-Based Questions — The Trees

“The trees inside are moving out into the forest.”

1. Why are the trees described as ‘inside’?

Answer: They are imagined as confined within a house.

2. Where are they moving?

Answer: Into the forest.

3. What does their movement symbolise?

Answer: Freedom and return to nature.

4. Which poetic device is central?

Answer: Personification.

“The roots work to disengage themselves from the cracks in the veranda floor.”

1. What are the roots doing?

Answer: They are freeing themselves from the floor.

2. Why are they doing it?

Answer: They are trying to escape confinement.

3. What does ‘work’ suggest?

Answer: Effort and determination.

4. What idea is symbolised?

Answer: The struggle for freedom.

“The glass is breaking.”

1. What is breaking?

Answer: The glass barrier.

2. Why does the glass break?

Answer: The trees push outward and the barrier cannot contain them.

3. What does it symbolise?

Answer: The removal of restrictions.

4. How does it contribute to the ending?

Answer: It marks liberation and movement into the open night.

14. Very Short Answer Questions

Q. Who wrote A Baker from Goa?

Answer: Lucio Rodrigues.

Q. Who wrote Coorg?

Answer: Lokesh Abrol.

Q. Who wrote Tea from Assam?

Answer: Arup Kumar Datta.

Q. What is a Goan baker called?

Answer: A pader.

Q. Which district is the smallest in Karnataka?

Answer: Coorg (Kodagu).

Q. What is Coorg famous for?

Answer: Coffee plantations, forests, spices, wildlife and scenic beauty.

Q. Which river is associated with Coorg?

Answer: The Kaveri.

Q. Who is Pranjal?

Answer: A boy from Assam whose father manages a tea plantation.

Q. Who wrote The Trees?

Answer: Adrienne Rich.

Q. Where are the trees trying to go?

Answer: Into the forest.

Q. What do the trees symbolise?

Answer: The desire for freedom and return to nature.

Q. What poetic device gives human qualities to trees?

Answer: Personification.

15. Short Answer Questions

Q. How does bread become a symbol of Portuguese influence in Goa?

Answer: Bread-making developed under Portuguese influence and became deeply integrated into Goan daily life and celebrations. The baker's furnace, dress, daily rounds and bread products preserve this cultural memory.

Q. Why does the narrator remember the baker with affection?

Answer: The baker is linked with the narrator's childhood. His arrival, the bread-bangles and family purchases create warm nostalgic memories.

Q. What makes Coorg an attractive tourist destination?

Answer: Its green forests, coffee plantations, spices, wildlife, streams, pleasant climate and opportunities for trekking and rafting make it attractive.

Q. What do the Kodavus' traditions reveal about them?

Answer: They reflect courage, hospitality, independence and a strong martial heritage.

Q. Why is Rajvir fascinated by Assam's tea gardens?

Answer: He has read about tea, its history and legends, so seeing endless plantations in reality excites him.

Q. How do the three parts celebrate India's diversity?

Answer: They present Goa through bread and Portuguese influence, Coorg through landscape and culture, and Assam through tea plantations and agricultural life.

Q. How does The Trees present the idea of freedom?

Answer: The trees are personified as beings trapped inside a house. Their roots, branches and leaves struggle outward until the barrier breaks and they return to the forest.

Q. Why is the forest important in The Trees?

Answer: It is the trees' natural home and symbolises freedom, belonging and unrestricted growth.

16. Long Answer Questions

Q. Explain how A Baker from Goa preserves a cultural tradition.

Answer: The chapter presents baking as a living part of Goan culture shaped by Portuguese influence. The baker arrives early, follows a familiar routine and carries traditional equipment. Bread is important for ordinary meals as well as festivals and marriages. Children eagerly wait for bread-bangles, while elders remember the old Portuguese days. The baker's profession therefore connects the present with the cultural past.

Q. Describe Coorg as presented in the chapter.

Answer: Coorg is a beautiful hill district of Karnataka located between Mysore and Mangalore. It has evergreen forests, coffee plantations, spices, wildlife, streams and pleasant weather. The Kodavus are known for courage, hospitality and martial traditions. Tourists can enjoy trekking, rafting, canoeing and wildlife experiences. The combination of natural beauty and distinctive culture makes Coorg a memorable part of India's regional diversity.

Q. What picture of Assam and the tea industry do you get from Tea from Assam?

Answer: The chapter presents Assam as a major tea-growing region with vast stretches of neatly pruned tea bushes. Rajvir and Pranjol see tea-pluckers working among the plantations. The chapter also discusses legends and history surrounding tea. It presents tea as both an important agricultural product and a familiar part of everyday life.

Q. How does Glimpses of India celebrate diversity?

Answer: The chapter presents three regions through distinctive traditions and landscapes. Goa is shown through bread-making and Portuguese influence; Coorg through forests, coffee, culture and martial traditions; Assam through tea plantations and legends. Together they reveal the richness of India's regional culture.

Q. Explain the symbolism of The Trees.

Answer: The trees symbolise living beings that have been confined and seek freedom. Their roots struggle against the veranda, branches move towards the glass and the trees finally enter the forest. The house represents restriction while the forest represents natural freedom.

Q. How does Adrienne Rich use personification in The Trees?

Answer: Rich gives the trees human qualities: roots 'work', branches move, leaves press outward and the trees appear determined to leave the house. This makes the struggle for freedom vivid and turns a natural scene into a symbolic story of liberation.

17. Value-Based Questions

Q. What can we learn from A Baker from Goa about preserving traditions?

Answer: Traditions survive when communities continue to practise and value them. Cultural practices should be respected, documented and passed to younger generations.

Q. What values are associated with the people of Coorg?

Answer: Courage, hospitality, independence, respect for tradition and community spirit are prominent values.

Q. What environmental lesson can be drawn from Coorg?

Answer: Forests, streams and wildlife depend on healthy ecosystems. Tourism and development should therefore be responsible and environmentally sensitive.

Q. What does The Trees teach about freedom?

Answer: Freedom is a fundamental need of living beings. The poem encourages respect for natural growth and resistance to unnecessary confinement.

18. Additional Important Questions

Q. Why does the baker's arrival create excitement among children?

Answer: His arrival means fresh bread and bread-bangles, which the children eagerly wait for.

Q. Why is the baker's profession described as profitable?

Answer: Bread is consumed regularly and is needed for social and religious occasions, ensuring steady demand.

Q. What makes the Kodavus distinctive?

Answer: Their cultural traditions, martial spirit, hospitality and historical associations make them distinctive.

Q. Why does Rajvir know more about tea than Pranjol expects?

Answer: Rajvir has read extensively about tea, its history and legends before visiting Assam.

Q. Why is tea connected with both legend and history?

Answer: The chapter presents traditional stories about tea's discovery alongside historical information about its spread and cultivation.

Q. What does the movement of trees tell us about nature?

Answer: Nature has its own rhythms and needs space to grow. Artificial confinement cannot permanently suppress natural forces.

Q. How does the title *The Trees* create curiosity?

Answer: Trees are normally expected to remain rooted. The title makes the reader curious about why and how they could move.

Q. What is the effect of the night setting in *The Trees*?

Answer: The night creates silence, mystery and a dream-like atmosphere, making the trees' movement more dramatic.

19. CBSE Exam-Oriented Questions

Q. Competency-based: A traditional occupation is disappearing because younger generations do not practise it. What lesson from *A Baker from Goa* is relevant?

Answer: Cultural traditions survive through practice, community respect and transmission to younger generations.

Q. Case-based: A tourist destination becomes popular but its forests begin to suffer. What lesson from *Coorg* should guide tourism?

Answer: Tourism should respect the environment. Forests, wildlife, water and local culture should be protected while tourism is developed responsibly.

Q. Competency-based: Rajvir has book knowledge while Pranjol has lived experience of tea gardens. How are both useful?

Answer: Book knowledge provides historical and factual background, while lived experience provides practical familiarity. Together they create a richer understanding.

Q. Analytical: 'Glimpses of India is a celebration of ordinary things that carry extraordinary cultural value.' Explain.

Answer: Bread, coffee landscapes, local customs and tea represent history, livelihood, regional identity and cultural memory. The chapter shows how everyday life contains important cultural meanings.

Q. Poem-based: If the trees symbolise freedom, what might the house symbolise?

Answer: The house can symbolise artificial confinement or conditions that prevent natural growth, while the forest represents freedom.

Q. Analytical: Why is personification especially effective in *The Trees*?

Answer: It presents the struggle for freedom as an active process. Instead of simply describing plants, the poet makes readers imagine conscious beings breaking free.

20. MCQs — Prose

1. A baker in Goa is traditionally called a:

A. pader B. Kodavu C. pradhan D. planter

2. Goan bread is linked strongly with:

A. Portuguese influence B. Mughal influence C. Tibetan influence D. French influence

3. Coorg is also known as:

- A. Kodagu B. Kalinga C. Malabar D. Konkan
4. Coorg is famous especially for:
A. tea B. coffee C. cotton D. jute
5. The river associated with Coorg is:
A. Ganga B. Kaveri C. Yamuna D. Narmada
6. Pranjol's father manages a:
A. coffee estate B. tea plantation C. spice shop D. bakery
7. Rajvir is fascinated by:
A. tea gardens B. desert dunes C. snow peaks D. ports
8. The three parts mainly highlight:
A. regional diversity B. political conflict C. urban life D. mythology only

21. MCQs — The Trees

1. Who wrote The Trees?
A. Adrienne Rich B. Robert Frost C. Carolyn Wells D. Leslie Norris
2. The trees are moving towards the:
A. city B. forest C. river D. mountain
3. The trees are mainly a symbol of:
A. wealth B. freedom C. war D. sleep
4. The roots are trying to free themselves from:
A. soil B. cracks in the veranda floor C. a river D. a wall
5. Which device is central to the poem?
A. personification B. pun C. satire D. parody
6. The house mainly symbolises:
A. freedom B. confinement C. celebration D. travel
7. The forest symbolises:
A. natural freedom B. fear C. wealth D. technology
8. The poem uses strong:
A. visual imagery B. comic dialogue C. historical facts D. dramatic dialogue

MCQ Answer Key

1-A, 2-A, 3-A, 4-B, 5-B, 6-B, 7-A, 8-A, 9-A, 10-B, 11-B, 12-B, 13-A, 14-B, 15-A, 16-A

22. Teacher's Note on Answer Writing

2–3 marks: Begin with a direct answer and support it with the relevant event/detail.

5–6 marks: Use a clear introduction, 3–4 developed points and a concluding statement. For analytical answers, explain evidence rather than merely stating an opinion.

Poetry: Mention the relevant image/device and explain its effect or symbolism. Avoid merely naming a poetic device.